Context-Switch Card Sort

Name: _____

Date: _____

Class / Period: _____

Unit / Lesson:
Unit 1: Budgeting & Planning — Lesson 1.2: Needs vs. Wants

DIRECTIONS

- You will sort sample spending cards into **Need**, **Want**, or **Gray Zone**. A gray-zone item is *something that could be a need or a want depending on the situation.*



HOW IT WORKS

1. **Sort** — Place each item in Need, Want, or Gray Zone.
2. **Think About Context** — Ask what situation might change the category.
3. **Explain** — Tell why you made your choice.

PART 1: FIRST SORT

Decide whether each item is a need, want, or gray-zone choice. Then explain your thinking.

Item	Need	Want	Gray Zone	Why?
Phone	☐	☐	☐	_____
Shoes	☐	☐	☐	_____
Laptop	☐	☐	☐	_____
Transportation	☐	☐	☐	_____
Internet/Data	☐	☐	☐	_____
Meal Purchase	☐	☐	☐	_____

Context-Switch Card Sort

PART 2: CONTEXT CHANGES EVERYTHING

Your teacher will reveal new information about one of the items. Write down what changed and whether you would move the item to a different category.

Item: _____

New information: _____

_____

Did it move? ☐ Yes ☐ No

New category: _____

Why did the context change the classification?

_____

_____

_____

REFLECT

Why is it useful to separate needs, wants, and gray-zone choices before making a spending plan?

_____

_____

_____

_____

BRING IT BACK TO YOUR WORKBOOK

You just saw that the same expense can change categories when the situation changes. Now return to Workbook p. 17 (Learn: Needs, Wants & the Gray Zone) and use that reasoning as we build the spending-plan order: Needs → Savings → Wants.

PRIVACY NOTE

Use sample or fictional information. Do not share personal spending, housing, family-income, account, or other private financial details.